

Wisdom Literature and Religious Experience <i>1 Kings 5:9 – 14 (4:29 – 34 NRSV) Proverbs 1 – 3, 8 & 9, Song of Songs 1 – 3, Ecclesiastes 1 – 3, Ezekiel 1:1 – 28a</i>	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • Solomon's wisdom as demonstrated in 1 Kings 5 (4 NRSV); • the concept of Wisdom in Proverbs including the presentation of Wisdom as a woman, the idea that the beginning of wisdom is fear of Hashem and the beginning of understanding is knowledge of the sacred; Wisdom as related not only to mystical aspects of religion but also social ethics; • the imagery of the Song of Songs; • the wonders and laws of the natural world, and belief in the creator G-d in Ecclesiastes; • the vision of Ezekiel and the omnipresence of G-d. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
---	---

Scripture references in Unit G583 are taken from *Tanach Mesorah Publications* and *Holy Bible NRSV*.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from – *Tanach Mesorah Publications* (1996) 0899062695.

3.13 G584: A2 *New Testament*

Candidates should be able to demonstrate thorough knowledge of the set texts and to be able to use them (in paraphrase) in their responses to examination questions.

New Testament background

Setting and methodology

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- Matthew: authorship and purpose; in particular Matthew's presentation of the Pharisees;
- Mark: purpose; in particular the influence on Mark's gospel of Nero's persecution;
- Luke: authorship and purpose; in particular Luke's interest in 'salvation history' and the gentiles.

Candidates should show knowledge and understanding of the first-century Jewish understanding of the following:

- apocalyptic and eschatology;
- parables;
- miracles;
- the Messiah.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Kingdom of God

Kingdom of God

Matthew 24, Mark 13, Luke 21:5–38, Matthew 6:9–13, Luke 11:20, Matthew 12:28, Mark 9:1, Matthew 16:28, Luke 9:27, Luke 17:20

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- modern scholarly interpretations of the coming of the Kingdom: future, realised, inaugurated;
- the Kingdom of God in the Synoptic Gospels: Jesus' expectation of the coming of the Kingdom; Jesus' views of the Kingdom in relationship with contemporary Judaism; Jesus' teaching on who now belongs to the people of God;
- eschatological outlook of each of the Synoptic Gospels with comparison of the Apocalyptic discourses (Matthew 24, Mark 13, Luke 21:5–end);
- the problem of the delay of the Parousia.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Parables

Mark 4, 12:1–12, Luke 15–16, Matthew 25

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- types of parable and their purpose: as saying, riddle, aphorism, rule and allegory;
- the message and purpose of Jesus' parables;
- parables and the nature of the Kingdom of God;
- parables and judgement and forgiveness;
- parables and inclusion/exclusion;
- parables about wealth and responsibility;
- parables about politics and nature of religion;
- parables about the lost and sinners;
- historicity: parables as product of Jesus and/or early church;
- debates about parables as allegory.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Miracles

Miracles

Mark 1:22–2:12, 3:21–30, 4:33–5:43, 6:32–52, 7:24–8:10, 8:22–26
Matthew 8:5–13,
Luke 7:1–10

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- Jewish concept of illness and the links to sin and demon possession;
- the purpose of Jesus' miracles: as indications of nature of the Kingdom of God; as forms of teaching; as revelation of God in nature; as power and presence of God in healings and exorcisms;
- theological significance of miracles for the Synoptic Gospel writers: failure of the disciples to understand miracles.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Law and ethics
Matthew 5–7, Mark 7 and 10:1–31

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the main features of Jesus' ethical teachings – attitude to Gentiles, to sinners and outcasts, to Jewish authority;
- Jesus' teaching on perfection and holiness, attitude to others and on love;
- the meaning of righteousness;
- reward and punishment;
- the place of forgiveness;
- the presentation of Jesus as teacher by Matthew, Mark and Luke;
- Jesus' challenge to the Jewish Law: ritual laws of cleansing, food and fasting, Sabbath regulations and teaching on marriage, divorce and wealth.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The Person of Jesus

Who was Jesus?
Mark 8:27–38, Matthew 10:23, Mark 11

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- Jesus as Messiah – did Jesus think he was the Messiah?
- Jesus as Son of Man: meaning of Son of Man; did Jesus think he was the Son of Man?
- Jesus as a restoration prophet;
- the historical Jesus: what can be known of the historical Jesus?, the criteria for establishing historical Jesus traditions.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from *Holy Bible NRSV* (Anglicized edition) Oxford University Press (1995) 0-19-107000-9.

Attempts to define religion

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the teaching of Feuerbach on religion;
- the teaching of Ninian Smart on religion;
- the teaching of Don Cupitt on religion;
- the teaching of the above thinkers on modernity and post-modernity.

Candidates should be able to discuss these teachings critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Exclusivist/particularist responses of Christianity to other world religions

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the underlying principles of theological exclusivism;
- the teaching of Karl Barth on religion: the Word, revelation, natural theology, election and universalism.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Inclusivist responses of Christianity to other world religions

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the underlying principles of theological inclusivism;
- the teaching of Karl Rahner on religion: open Catholicism, Grace, history and creation, Church, anonymous Christian and anonymous Christianity.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Pluralist responses of Christianity to other world religions

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the underlying principles of theological pluralism;
- the teaching of John Hick on religion: religious experience, global theology, use of Kant, the Real, demythologising and divinity of Christ.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Presentation of women in the Bible and Christian tradition	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • presentation of women in the Old Testament; • presentation of women in the New Testament; • views of Augustine, Luther and <i>Mulieris Dignitatem</i> on gender and the relationship of women and men. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.
Liberal/equality feminist theology	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • aims of secular liberal or equality feminisms: rights, autonomy and patriarchy; • response of liberal or equality feminist theologies to secular liberal and equality feminism; • liberal feminist theology interpretation of the place and presentation of women in the Bible. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.
Reconstruction feminist theology	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • aims of secular reconstructionist feminisms: existential, Marxist, Freudian; • responses of reconstructionist feminist theologies to secular reconstructionist feminisms; • feminist theology's revisionist/reconstructionist views of women in Christian history; use of the hermeneutic of suspicion; • feminist re-imaging/reconstruction of the language of God; language and the Trinity. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.
Radical/naturalist feminist theology	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • aims of secular radical and naturalist feminists: body, difference and androgyny; • responses of radical and naturalist feminist theologians to body, difference and androgyny; • alternative Christian theology: Elaine Pagels; • post-Christian feminism: Mary Daly. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

Feminist theological ethics

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- role of women as ministers/priests/bishops: responses of feminist theology and non-feminist theology to the role of women as leaders in the Church;
- role of women as mothers: responses of feminist theology and non-feminist theology to motherhood and reproduction;
- Womanist theology: problems for women of colour of racism and sexual exploitation.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically and their strengths and weaknesses.

nibbana/nirvana

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the nature of nibbana and parinibbana;
- the difficulty of describing nibbana and the ways in which this is attempted;
- the desirability of nibbana.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The Importance of Scriptures

The Lotus Sutra

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the importance of the Lotus Sutra in establishing Mahayana authority;
- the interpretations and importance of the parable of the burning house;
- upaya and ekayana.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The Heart Sutra

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the importance of the Heart Sutra as a prajnaparamita text;
- sunyata.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The Pali Canon

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the Pali Canon;
- the importance of the tripitaka;
- the division of the text into the sutta pitaka, vinaya pitaka and abhidhamma pitaka.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Religious Practice

Meditation

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- aims and methods and results of meditation, including samatha and vipassana meditation;
- different methods of meditation including the use of koans, zazen, nembutsu, visualisations and mandalas;
- experiences of satori and jhanas.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Zen Buddhism	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • aims, practices, attitudes of Zen Buddhism to scripture; • differences between Rinzai and Soto schools. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Pure Land Buddhism	Candidates should understand the following: • aims, practices, attitudes of Pure Land Buddhism to scripture; • an awareness of the differences between Pure Land and True Pure Land schools. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Tibetan Buddhism	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • aims, practices, attitudes of Tibetan Buddhism to scripture; • the authority and status of the Dalai Lama. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Buddhism in the west	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • Buddhist developments in the west; • western interpretations and adaptations of the vinaya; • psychological interpretations of Buddhist cosmology. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Ethics	
The five precepts	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the five precepts; • positive and negative interpretations of the five precepts; • implications of the precepts for the development of the ethical codes. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Implications for ethics of the eightfold path	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the relationship between sila, prajna and samadhi; • implications of the path for the development of the ethical codes. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

upaya, karuna and prajna

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the concepts of upaya, karuna and prajna;
- the relationship between wisdom and compassion in Buddhist ethics;
- the implications of upaya for ethical codes.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from *Buddhist Scriptures*, trans. E. Conze, Penguin, (1969), 0140440887.

Liberation	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: - the nature of liberation in different Hindu schools; - different paths to liberation. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The Advaita Vedanta of Sankara	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following concepts within the Advaita Vedanta: - relationship between atman and Brahman; - maya; - jnana; - monism; - nature of liberation. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The Vishishtadvaita Vedanta of Ramanuja	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the following concepts within the Vishishtadvaita Vedanta: - relationship between atman and Brahman; - the world as the body of God; - bhakti; - nature of liberation. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The Importance of Scriptures	
The Vedas	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: - the importance and structure of the Vedas; - the nature of God in the Vedas. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The Bhagavad Gita	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: - the importance of the Bhagavad Gita; - the nature of God; - dharma; - bhakti; - karma; - relationship between Krishna and Arjuna. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Meditation	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • aims, methods and results of meditation. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
samkhya and yoga	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • aims, methods and results of samkhya; • relationship between purusa and prakriti; • nature of the three gunas; • nature of liberation. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Later Hindu Developments	
MK Gandhi	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the religious thoughts of Gandhi; • the influence of Gandhi on Hindu thought and practice. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Arya Samaj	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the religious attitudes and developments of the Arya Samaj and their influence on Hindu thought and practice. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Brahmo Samaj	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the religious attitudes and developments of the Brahmo Samaj and their influence on Hindu thought and practice. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Hinduism in the west	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the development of Hinduism in the west; • western interpretations of the class system; • western movements: ISKCON; • Vivekananda and the Ramakrishna Mission. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

ahimsa	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the concept of ahimsa; • the background to the concept of ahimsa and its importance for Hindu ethics. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Implications for ethics of varnashramadharm	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the concept of varnashramadharm; • the extent to which varnashramadharm is followed and its influence on Hindu ethics. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
The four purusharthas	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: • the importance of and relationship between artha, kama, dharma and moksha. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from – Zaehner, R. C. (tr & ed) *Hindu Scriptures* Everyman's Library (1992) 1-85715-064-3.

Articles of belief: Allah, angels, scriptures, messengers, the last day, the divine decree

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the articles of belief (Allah, angels, scriptures, messengers, the last day, the divine decree);
- their particular significance and importance in Muslim theology.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Scripture

Surah 4



Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the teachings of Surah 4 in relation to the treatment of women in pre-Islamic Arabia; the importance of these teachings for Muslims today;
- the changes which Muhammad introduced;
- the principles of first ummah;
- teachings about orphans, family and the roles of men and women, inheritance, Jews and Christians, enemies, hypocrites, jihad, and articles of belief.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Muslim Life

Qur'an, Sunnah and Shari'ah as bases for Muslim life; ijtiḥad

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the nature and importance of each of these and how they form the bases for Muslim life;
- teaching on work and wealth;
- teaching on justice, crime and punishment.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The concept of jihad

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- jihad as 'striving for the will of Allah';
- be able to distinguish between Greater and Lesser Jihad.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The ummah and its implications for Muslim ethics	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: - the theological basis and practical implications of this 'worldwide community of Muslims'; - the importance of ummah in the way in which it can influence and affect Muslim ethics. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Development of Islam	
The first four Khalifahs and the spread of Islam to 732 CE	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: - the importance of the first four Khalifahs: Abu Bakr, 'Umar ibn al-Khattab, 'Uthman, Ali; - the expansion of Islam to 732 CE (when the Muslim forces were defeated at Poitiers by Charles Martel's Franks). Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Origins and beliefs of Sunni and Shi'a Islam	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: - the split between Sunni and Shi'a Islam; - the different Shi'a groups of Seveners and Twelvers; Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Origins and beliefs of Sufi Islam	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of Sufi Islam: its origins and goals as a mystical group within Islam. Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.
Practice of Islam in the Western World	Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of: challenges to family and community values posed by non-Islamic world (including how this affects Muslims in United Kingdom). Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from – Abdullah, Yusuf Ali, *The Meaning of the Holy Qur'an* Amana Publications (1995) (seventh edition) 0-915957-55-8.

The concept of the Land of Israel

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the significance of the concept of the Land of Israel for Judaism;
- its historical context as the 'Promised Land';
- exile and return;
- Zionism;
- the relationship between the religious idea and the present day State of Israel;
- the difference between the concept of the Promised Land and the present day State of Israel – this should include origins and the boundaries of the land;
- concepts related to the Land such as stewardship, the Year of Jubilees, the establishment of kibbutzim and Jewish responses to environmental issues;
- the teachings of Judah Halevi in relation to the Promised Land.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Messianic hope

Messianic hope, with reference to Isaiah and Malachi

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the importance attached to the Messianic hope by Jews;
- various interpretations and understandings of this hope today, eg the contrast between the way in which this is understood and interpreted by Orthodox and Progressive Jewish groups;
- the idea of the Messianic hope in the books of Isaiah and Malachi;
- different understandings of the idea of Messianic hope as represented by different groups of Jews today, the teachings as represented in Maimonides;
- the *13 Principles of Faith* including study of the Messiah;
- different Jewish beliefs about life after death.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The twentieth-century Holocaust and post-Holocaust theology

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the origins and scale of the twentieth-century Holocaust;
- anti-semitism;
- the twentieth-century Holocaust and its effects on world Jewry;
- the physical consequences on world Jewry and the particular theology which has resulted from it: the thinking of Rubenstein, Fackenheim, Maybaum and Berkovitz;
- Orthodox and Progressive responses to the Holocaust.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Developments in Judaism

Orthodoxy, Neo-Orthodoxy, Conservative, Reform, Progressive and Liberal; Hasidic Tradition

Candidates should be able to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of:

- the origins and teachings of these groups as they are represented in the United Kingdom;
- the principal theological differences between them and the way in which these may be reflected in and affect Jewish life and practice.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

The diaspora: Ashkenazi and Sephardi Jews

Candidates should understand the following:

- the establishment of the diaspora;
- the origins and differing practices of Ashkenazi and Sephardi Jews;
- identity and cultural diversity.

Candidates should be able to discuss these areas critically.

Where quotes from texts appear in examination papers, they will be taken from – *Tanach Mesorah Publications* (1996) 0899062695, *The Complete Art Scroll Siddur Mesorah Publications* (1984) 0-89-906655-0.

4.1 AS GCE Scheme of Assessment

Candidates choose any **two** units from the **nine** options listed below.

Candidates should note that any areas within the units selected can be examined in any combination and coverage of all areas in the units chosen is required.

No Bibles or other texts may be taken into examinations.

AS GCE Religious Studies (H172)

G571: AS *Philosophy of Religion*

50% of the total AS GCE marks
1.5 h written paper
70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** two-part essay questions from a choice of **four**.

Topics and themes in philosophy of religion.

G572: AS *Religious Ethics*

50% of the total AS GCE marks
1.5 h written paper
70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** two-part essay questions from a choice of **four**.

Ethical theories and certain topics in practical religious ethics.

G573: AS *Jewish Scriptures*

50% of the total AS GCE marks
1.5 h written paper
70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** two-part essay questions from a choice of **four**.

Highlighted themes and texts within the Jewish Scriptures.

G574: AS *New Testament*

50% of the total AS GCE marks
1.5 h written paper
70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** two-part essay questions from a choice of **four**.

Gospels – highlighted themes and texts.

G575: AS *Developments in Christian Theology*

50% of the total AS GCE marks
1.5 h written paper
70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** two-part essay questions from a choice of **four**, with a choice of **one** from **two** in Part 1 and **one** from **two** in Part 2.

Highlighted themes within modern Christian Theology.

G576: AS *Buddhism*

50% of the total AS GCE marks
1.5 h written paper

Candidates are required to answer **two** two-part essay questions from a choice of **four**.

50% of the total AS GCE marks	Candidates are required to answer two two-part essay
1.5 h written paper	questions from a choice of four .
70 marks	Origins of Hinduism and certain key beliefs and practices.

50% of the total AS GCE marks	Candidates are required to answer two two-part essay
1.5 h written paper	questions from a choice of four .
70 marks	Origins of Islam and certain key beliefs and practices.

G579: AS *Judaism*

50% of the total AS GCE marks	Candidates are required to answer two two-part essay
1.5 h written paper	questions from a choice of four .
70 marks	Key beliefs and practices within Judaism.

4.2 Advanced GCE Scheme of Assessment

Candidates choose any **two** units from the **nine** options listed below.

Candidates should note that any areas within the units selected can be examined in any combination and coverage of all areas in the units chosen is required.

No Bibles or other texts may be taken into examinations.

Advanced GCE Religious Studies (H572)

AS Units as above, G571–9, each being 25% of the total Advanced GCE marks.

G581: A2 *Philosophy of Religion*

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks

1.5 h written paper

70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** open essay style questions from a choice of **four**.

Themes in philosophy of religion relating to authority, language and life and death.

G582: A2 *Religious Ethics*

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks

1.5 h written paper

70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** open essay style questions from a choice of **four**.

Ethical issues relating to authority and destiny. Further topics in practical religious ethics.

G583: A2 *Jewish Scriptures*

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks

1.5 h written paper

70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** open essay style questions from a choice of **four**.

Highlighted themes and texts dealing with authority, life and death and experience.

G584: A2 *New Testament*

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks

1.5 h written paper

70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** open essay style questions from a choice of **four**.

Highlighted themes and texts dealing with authority, life and death and experience.

G585: A2 *Developments in Christian Theology*

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks

1.5 h written paper

70 marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** essay questions from a choice of **four**, with a choice of **one** from **two** in Part 1 and **one** from **two** in Part 2.

Certain themes within modern Christian Theology dealing with authority, life and death and experience.

G586: A2 *Buddhism*

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks

Candidates are required to answer **two** open essay style questions from a choice of **four**.

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks 1.5 h written paper 70 marks	Candidates are required to answer two open essay style questions from a choice of four . Themes relating to authority and truth, life and death and experience.
--	--

G588: A2 *Islam*

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks 1.5 h written paper 70 marks	Candidates are required to answer two open essay style questions from a choice of four . Themes relating to authority and truth, life and death and experience.
--	--

G589: A2 *Judaism*

25% of the total Advanced GCE marks 1.5 h written paper 70 marks	Candidates are required to answer two open essay style questions from a choice of four . Themes relating to authority and truth, life and death and experience.
--	--

4.3 Unit Order

The normal order in which the unit assessments could be taken is AS Units **G571** to **G579** in the first year of study, leading to an AS GCE award, then A2 Units **G581** to **G589** leading to the Advanced GCE award. However, the unit assessments may be taken in any order.

4.4 Unit Options (at AS/A2)

For AS GCE Religious Studies candidates must take **two** units from AS Units **G571** to **G579**.

For Advanced GCE Religious Studies candidates take **two** AS Units, *and* **two** A2 Units.

Each unit has nine options. Candidates can study any two options at AS and any two options at A2, though it is recommended that candidates study the same units at A2 that they studied at AS.

AS units	A2 units
AS Philosophy of Religion	A2 Philosophy of Religion
AS Religious Ethics	A2 Religious Ethics
AS Jewish Scriptures	A2 Jewish Scriptures
AS New Testament	A2 New Testament
AS Developments in Christian Theology	A2 Developments in Christian Theology
AS Buddhism	A2 Buddhism

ynoptic Assessment (A Level GCE)

ssessment is included wholly in the final A2 Units.

ssessment tests the candidates' understanding of the connections between different elements of the subject. It encourages the development of derstanding of the subject. In this specification, synoptic assessment is addressed throughout both A2 units. In order to encourage this holistic to the subject, topics that are intrinsically synoptic, ie those that require candidates to think about certain theological themes, have been mapped 2 content. Therefore whichever units candidates study at A2 they will be addressing these broader themes. The A2 Synoptic themes are outline below.

Concept of deity and relationship with humanity	Authority and truth in religion	Experience and religion	The Human Condition
--	--	--------------------------------	----------------------------